

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

How Technology Changes The Way The World Works



Learning Outcome:

Identify key information about people's jobs and places of work in spoken or written contexts.

Design the technological architecture of the IT system, through hardware and software recognition, based on available technology in the market, the analysis report and the distribution diagram.

Can Do Statements:

- I can read about new trends in management information systems.
- I can write a simple text to explain the future of management information systems.
- I can give examples about different options to manage information systems in business.

Ask your partner:

- How do you think synchronizing devices such as smartphones and laptops can help you or a company to be more productive?
- If you were the CEO or IT officer in a company, what information technologies would you be interested in implementing? Why?



Let's Explore!

A company's CEO is reading an article about new trends in management information systems.



Instructions: Read the text below.

You can keep doing business the way you usually do or you could try to improve by using the new business productivity applications that run on mobile-device-based or web-based technologies. The era of paper-based letters, memos, circulars and other documents alike is a matter of the past. Companies that want to keep up with changes, must adapt to new technologies. Computers and specially software applications gradually transform the way companies should do business and manage their operations. Just imagine how email messaging and videoconferencing are now the new standard form of documents and the most practical form of communication. We can now send hundreds of emails and talk to people located everywhere in the world in real time, making businesses save millions of dollars a year.

But that's not all. Technology keeps evolving and more productivity applications are emerging. Handheld devices like smartphones and tablets are becoming an important driving force for communications and business operations. We cannot forget the tremendous impact that cloud computing and collaborative work are creating on the way businesses work. We know for a fact that these technology trends are becoming more relevant and anyone who wants to take advantage of their benefits, has to stay up to date with them. Not only start-ups but also large firms are investing heavily in these technologies. It is evident that we will see in the near future companies that will provide employees with sophisticated smartphones to synchronize tasks, calendars and entire projects, all via these devices and the use of specialized applications.

For example, we might see doctors checking up patients online and getting all the information they need like the patient's record by keeping their mobiles synched with those of their colleagues, nurses, vendors from pharmaceutical labs and administrative staff. Sales representatives, for instance, might get in touch with their clients and monitor their needs via telephone messaging apps. Besides, due to cloud information storage on the web, it wouldn't matter if you lived in Canada, China or Chile as videoconferencing and collaborative work will be easier than ever.



**Let's Practice!**

What is changing in MIS?

Instructions: Use the words from the word bank to complete each sentence.

try / to use / trying / transforms / use transform /

The CEO is reading an article. It says you can _____ to speed up your business productivity by using new business applications that run on mobile-device-based technologies. A great advantage is that you don't have _____ paper documents to get and analyze data anymore as it can be done much faster using computers. All in all, computers and specially software applications could _____ the way you do business and manage your operations.

**Let's Practice!**

I still have doubts about MIS.

Instructions: Complete each sentence by writing the missing words.

1. We could improve p _ _ d _ _ _ _ _ _ _ y by using new mobile applications.
2. We should use _ _ f _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ systems to collect and analyze data. This will surely speed up many of the processes in our company.
3. We must use the new w _ _ - b _ _ _ _ applications to plan the schedule for the tasks we need to carry out in the company.



Extension Activity

Let's discuss about trends in management information systems.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Search for information about trends in management information systems.
- Identify the strongest trends that you think will make a change in organizations.
- Write down a paragraph explaining which trends will be stronger in the future of organizations and why.
- Share your paragraph with your class and discuss the topic.



Target Words

- **alike** (adjective): similar to or the same to another
e.g. The era of paper-based letters, memos, circulars and other documents alike is a matter of the past.
- **email messaging** (noun): a way of sending and receiving messages from other individuals via telecommunications using a specialized software
e.g. Just imagine how email messaging and videoconferencing are now the new standard form of documents and the most practical form of communication.
- **handheld device** (noun): a small enough computer that can be held in an individual's pocket or hand
e.g. Handheld devices like smartphones and tablets are becoming an important driving force for communications and business operations.

Self-Assessment

Yes
No

- I search for information about trends in management information.
- I identify the strongest trends that you think will make a change in organizations.
- I write down a paragraph explaining which trends will be stronger in the future of organizations.
- I share information and discuss the topic.

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- **heavily** (adverb): a lot, greatly or widely
e.g. Not only start-ups but also large firms are investing heavily in these technologies.
- **patient's record** (noun): the collection of documents and information about treatments, medicine, illnesses of a patient
e.g. We might see doctors checking up patients online and getting all the information they need like the patient's record by keeping their mobiles synched with those of their colleagues.
- **do business** (noun): to close deals or have business relations with other parties
e.g. Computers and specially software applications gradually transform the way companies should do business and manage their operations.





Learning Points

Modal Verbs Review: Can, Have To, Should, Must, Could

Modal verbs are auxiliary verbs that cannot work as the main verb in a sentence. They are used to express possibility, obligation, advisability, request, necessity and ability.

Advisability

We can use **modal verbs** to give advice, recommendation and suggestions to someone. The most common **modal verbs** we use for this purpose are:

- should
- must
- could
- can

Examples:

- *To speed up the process of internal verbal communication, you **should try** to implement mobile-based technologies.*
- *If you are really interested in saving money, you **must make** use of cloud computing services in your company.*

Probability

We can use **modal verbs** to express certainty and uncertainty. Depending on how certain we feel about someone or something, we may use any of the modal verbs outlined below:

- could (less certain)
- may (fairly more uncertain)
- might (the most uncertain)

Example:

- *Samantha sent me a text message. She says she **could try** to attend the meeting today. On the other hand, Charles phoned me. He said he has too much office work. However, he **might attend** the meeting if he's able to finish by tomorrow.*

Obligation

We can use **modal verbs** to express obligation or that something is mandatory. For this, we can use the following **modal verbs**:

- have to (external imposition)
- must (personal imposition)

Example:

- *The IT department implemented a security protocol for all the company's employees. We **have to enter** a double password to get access to our email account.*

Ability

Finally, we can use the verb **can** to express that someone has the ability to do something.

Example:

- *I **can make** companies save money by streamlining processes thanks to the use of information technologies. I'm really savvy on it.*





Learning Points

Examples

- *You can keep doing business the way you usually do or you could try to improve by using the new business productivity applications that run on mobile-device-based or web-based technologies.*
- *Companies that want to keep up with changes, must adapt to new technologies.*
- *We know for a fact that these technology trends are becoming more relevant and anyone who wants to take advantage of their benefits, has to stay up to date with them.*

Future Tenses Review: Will, Might

We can use the verbs **will** and **might** to refer to future actions or events.

Depending on how certain we feel about a future situation or how sure we are that something is going to take place, we may choose between the verbs **will** and **might**. **Will** expresses a much stronger certainty and we use it to talk about plans or established events in the future.

Examples:

*Tomorrow, we **will** restructure the code and hire new employees to finish the project. We **will** go over all the requirements for information management systems in next week's meeting.*

On the other hand, when we want to express that we are not entirely sure about a future event, we can use the verb **might**.

Examples:

*We **might** be able to improve the processes in the company if we assess the metrics we are using.*

*I'm not entirely sure, but we **might** have a meeting tomorrow morning.*

Examples

- *It is evident that we will see in the near future companies that will provide employees with sophisticated smartphones to synchronize tasks, calendars, an entire projects via these machines.*
- *We might see doctors checking up patients online and getting all the information they need like the patient's record by keeping their mobiles synched with those of their colleagues, nurses, vendors from pharmaceutical labs and administrative staff.*

